RESEARCH NOTE

Costa Brava Tourism: Data & Trends

Accommodation supply and demand, 2007–2025

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Public data: Idescat

How have the supply of and demand for tourist accommodation on the Costa Brava evolved since 2007?

TRAVELLERS[1]

4,12M → 5,69M

+38,1%

2007 to 2025, hotels, campsites and rural tourism

OVERNIGHT STAYS[1]

17,94M → 21,92M

+22,2%

2007 to 2025, same three types

REGISTERED HOTEL PLACES[1]

71.097 → 75.076

+5,6%

2007 to 2025, three comarques

REGISTERED TOURIST DWELLINGS

19.728 → 42.185

+113,8%

2015 to 2025, three comarques

IN THIS NOTE

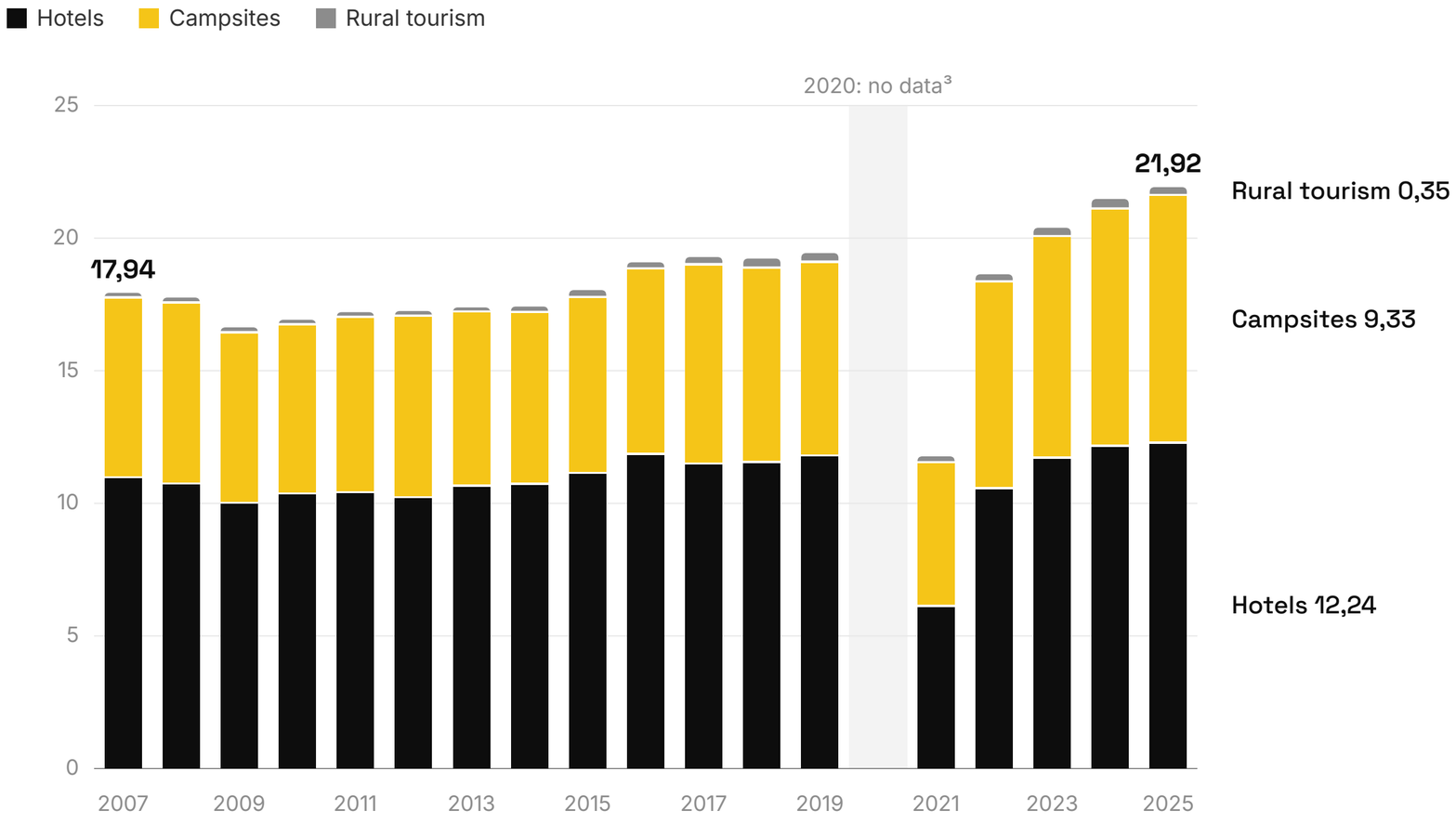
3	What is measured
4	Accommodation supply by type
5–6	Hotels
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11	Limits, sources and method

[1] M = millions. Hotels include hostels and guesthouses, as in the hotel survey. Travellers and overnight stays cover hotels, campsites and rural tourism. Tourist dwellings have supply data only. Supply is the sum of the comarques Alt Empordà, Baix Empordà and La Selva; demand is the Costa Brava tourist brand.

Source: Idescat, tourist accommodation statistics (hotels, campsites, rural tourism, supply); author's calculations.

Three accommodation types have demand data; tourist dwellings have supply data only.

Overnight stays by accommodation type, in millions



DATA AVAILABLE

Type	Demand[1]	Supply[1]	Period
Hotels	Travellers, nights, occupancy; monthly	Places	2007–2025
Campsites	Travellers, nights, occupancy; quarterly	Places	Places from 2011, rest 2007–2025
Rural tourism	Travellers, nights, occupancy; quarterly	Places	2007–2025
Tourist dwellings	No demand data	Registered dwellings[2]	2015–2025
Tourist apartments	No demand data	Establishments, places	2015–2025; not analysed

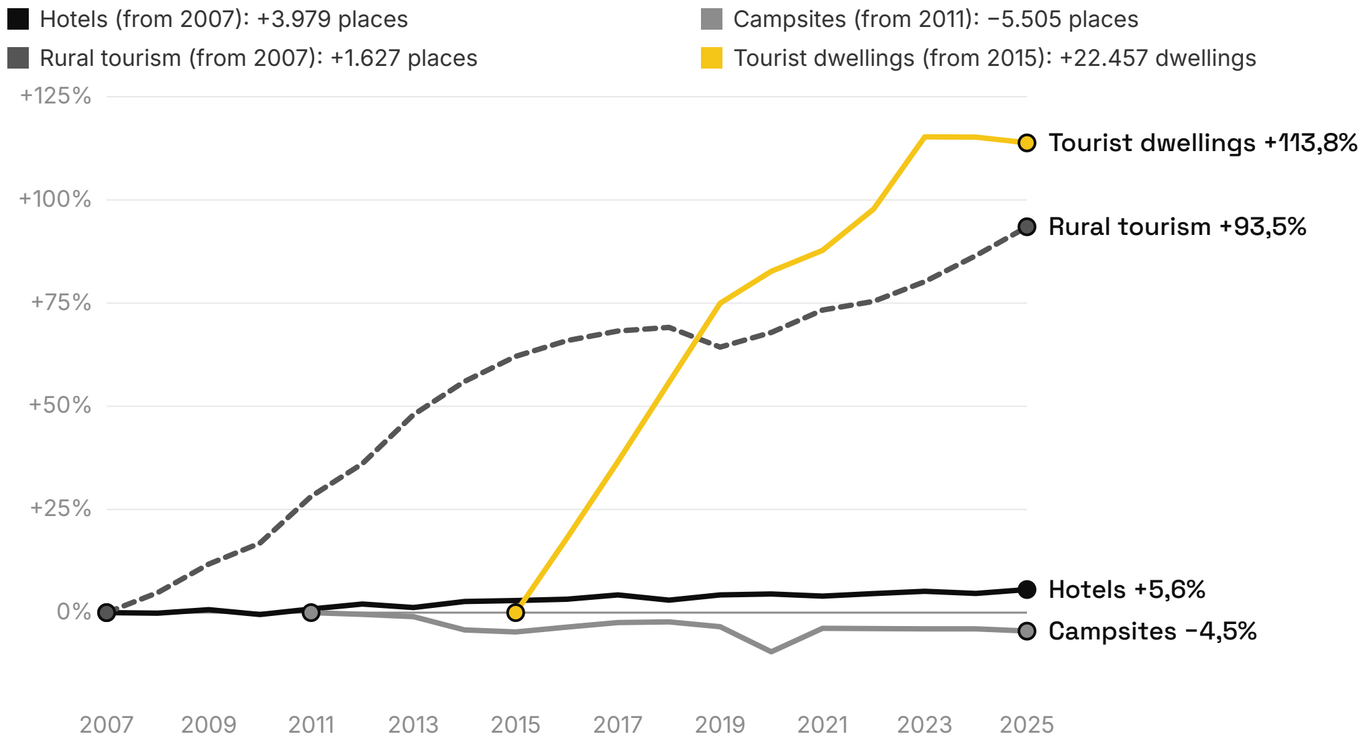
NOTES

1. Hotels include hostels and guesthouses, as in the hotel survey. Demand: Costa Brava tourist brand. Supply: comarques Alt Empordà, Baix Empordà and La Selva, an approximation.
2. Dwelling places are 5,5 times the dwellings in every year, so dwellings are counted.
3. Months or quarters of 2020 are missing in the source for all three types.

Source: Idescat, tourist accommodation statistics (EOH and supply of tourist establishments); author's calculations.

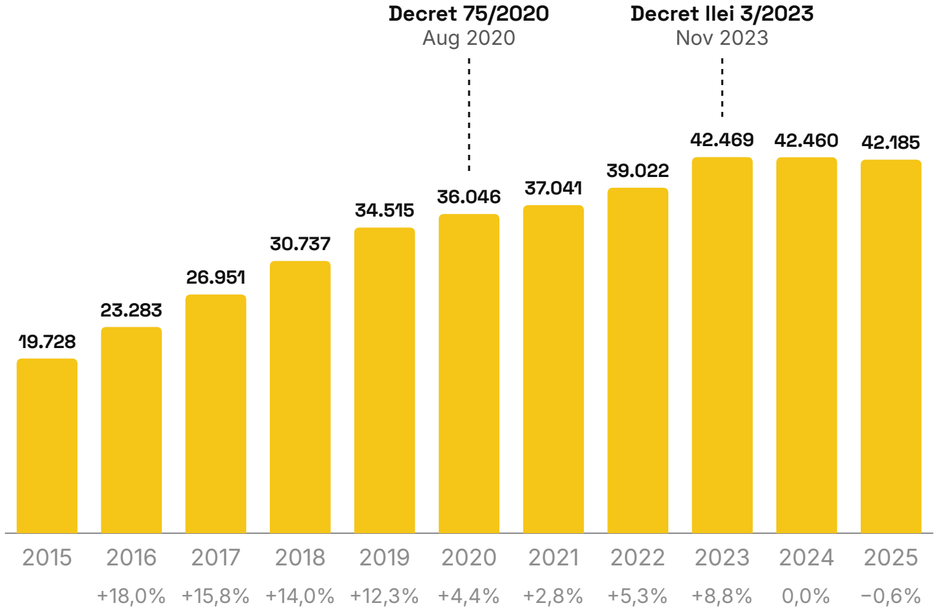
Registered hotel and campsite places changed little; rural tourism places nearly doubled and tourist dwellings more than doubled.

Change in registered supply since the first year, %[1]



Registered tourist dwellings, number[2]

Year-on-year change below each year; regulation dates marked[3]



1 Each line starts at 0% in its first comparable year (campsite places only from 2011, dwellings from 2015); the legend gives the absolute change over the same period. Hotels (including hostels and guesthouses), campsites and rural tourism: places; tourist dwellings: dwellings. Supply: comarques Alt Empordà, Baix Empordà and La Selva.

2 Idescat places for dwellings are 5,5 times the dwellings in every year, so dwellings are shown. Registered is not in use: there is no demand or occupancy data for dwellings.

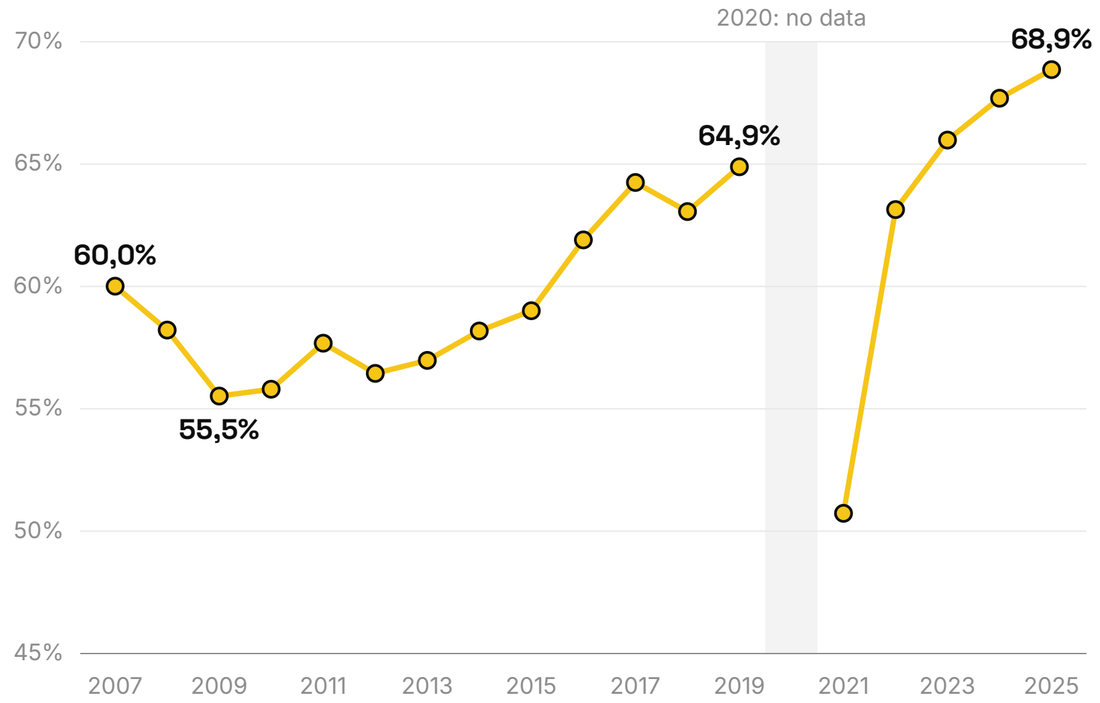
3 Decret 159/2012 (Nov 2012), before the series starts, regulated tourist dwellings. The marks show the dates of Decret 75/2020 and Decret llei 3/2023 (urban-planning licence required before registration); the data do not show cause.

Source: Idescat, supply of tourist accommodation establishments (Departament d'Empresa i Ocupació); author's calculations.

Hotel occupancy rose from 60,0% to 68,9% and the average stay fell from 3,57 to 2,98 nights.

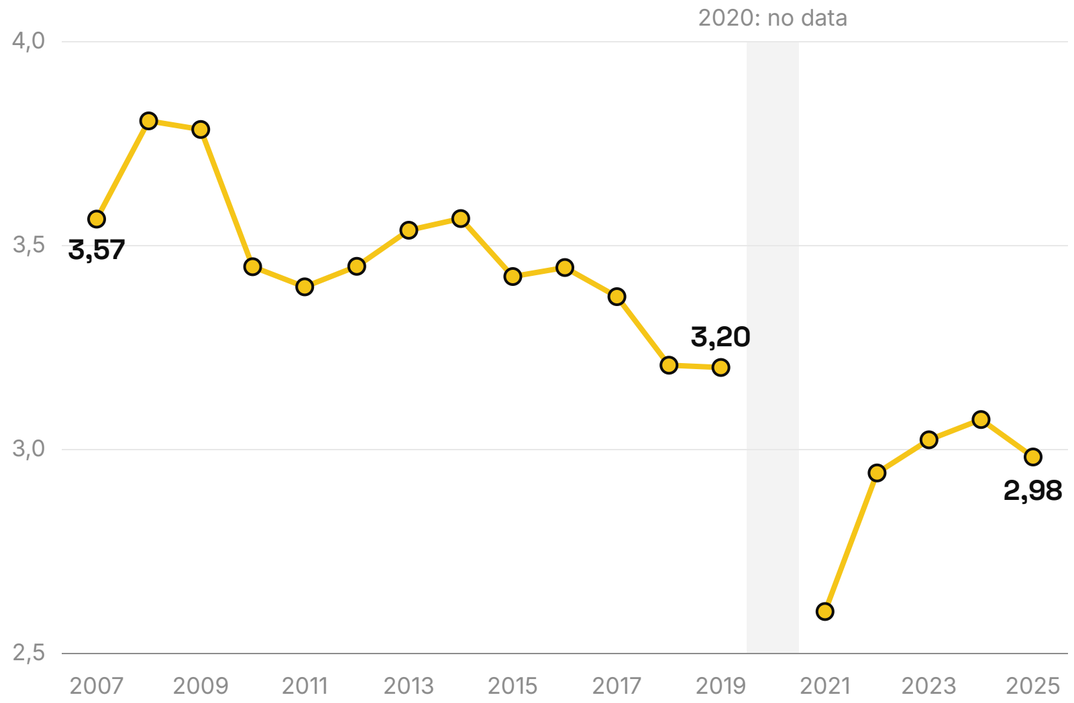
Annual hotel occupancy, % of available bed-nights[1,2]

Costa Brava tourist brand, hotels



Average length of stay, nights per traveller[3]

Costa Brava tourist brand, hotels



1 Annual occupancy is overnight stays divided by available bed-nights, derived from the published monthly rates. No annual figure for 2020: April to June 2020 are missing in the source. Hotels include hostels and guesthouses, as in the survey.

2 Occupancy is nights divided by available bed-nights. Between 2007 and 2025 nights rose from 10,93 M to 12,24 M (+12,0%) and the available bed-nights implied by the published rates fell from 18,21 M to 17,78 M (−2,4%), so both raise the rate. The survey measures occupancy on the places estimated as open each month, not on registered places. Registered hotel places rose from 71.097 to 75.076 (+5,6%).

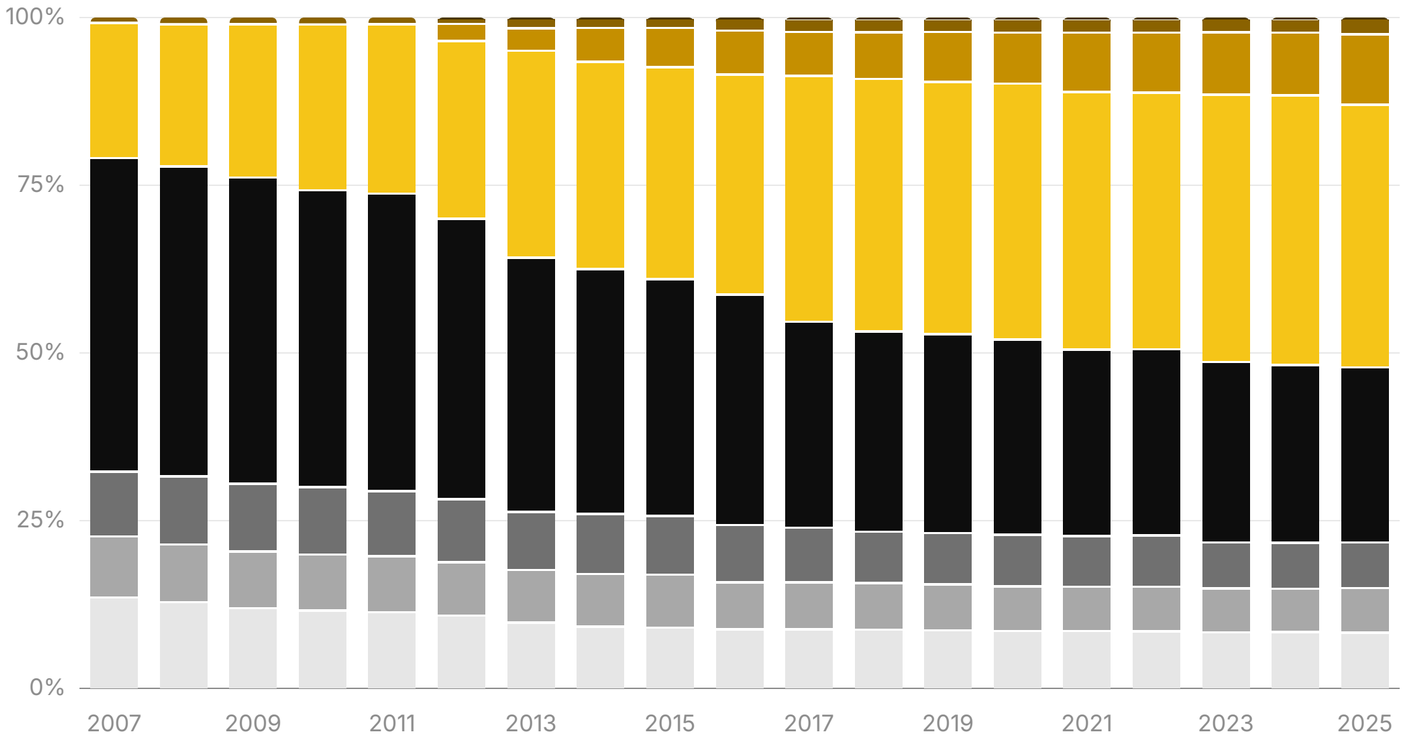
3 Average length of stay is overnight stays divided by travellers, on annual totals. Same missing months in 2020.

Source: Idescat, hotel occupancy survey (EOH) and supply of tourist establishments; author's calculations.

Places in 4-star or higher categories rose from 21,1% to 52,3% of registered places; 3-star fell from 46,8% to 26,1%.

Registered places by category, % of places in hotels, hostels and guesthouses[1]

Costa Brava comarques, 2007–2025



SHARE OF PLACES, %

Category[2,3]	2007	2025	Change, pp
4 stars or above	**21,1**	**52,3**	**+31,2**
Gran luxe	–	0,4	–
5 stars	1,0	2,3	+1,3
4 stars superior	–	10,5	–
4 stars	20,1	39,1	+19,0
3 stars	46,8	26,1	−20,7
2 stars	9,6	6,8	−2,8
1 star	9,2	6,7	−2,5
Hostels and guesthouses	13,3	8,1	−5,2

1 Registered places in hotels, hostels and guesthouses (71.097 in 2007, 75.076 in 2025), the same total as on pages 4 and 5. Supply is the sum of the comarques Alt Empordà, Baix Empordà and La Selva.

2 4 stars superior and gran luxe are registered from 2011 (0,0% that year), so they have no 2007 figure. Colours run from light grey (hostels, guesthouses) through black (3 stars) to yellow and dark yellow (higher categories).

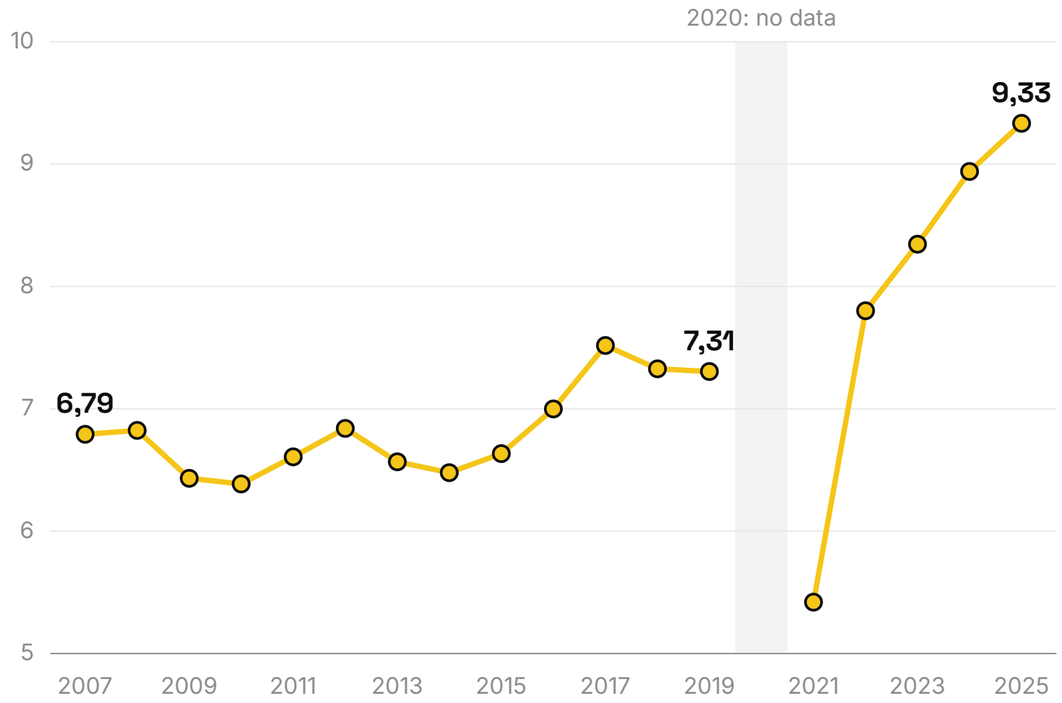
3 The register shows places by category, not hotels: it cannot separate hotels that changed category from new or refurbished ones, and it has no information on prices or spending.

Source: Idescat, supply of tourist accommodation establishments (Departament d'Empresa i Ocupació); author's calculations.

Campsites added 2,54 M overnight stays, the most of the three types; their July–September share fell from 76,1% to 65,2%.

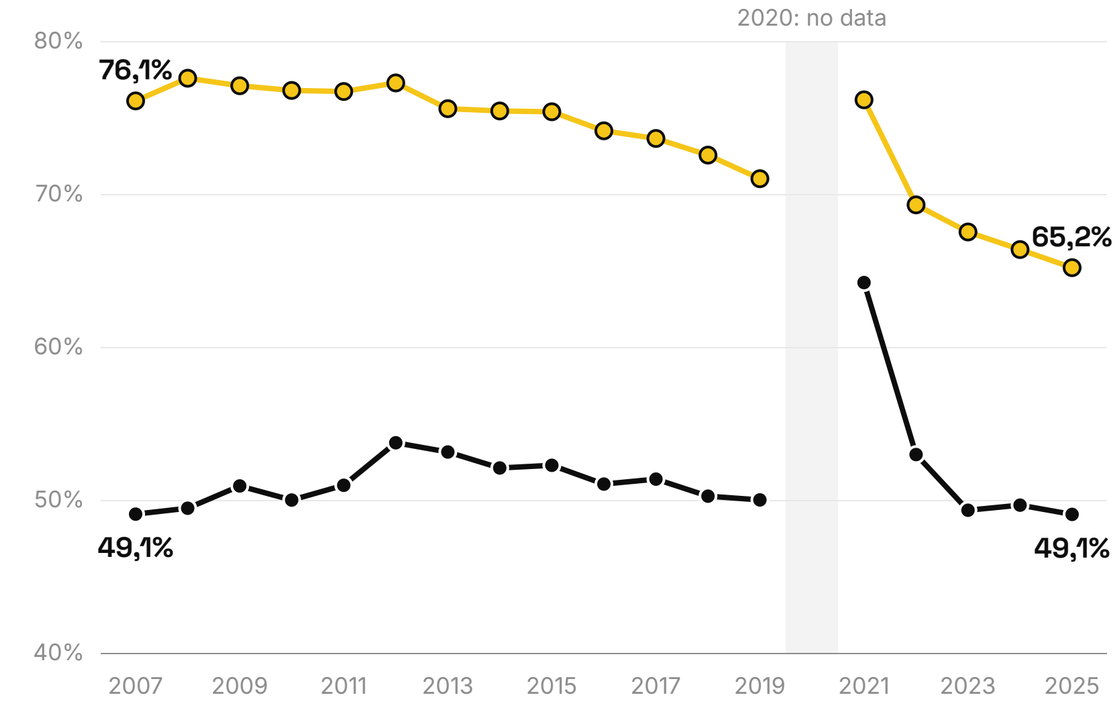
Campsite overnight stays, in millions[1]

Costa Brava tourist brand, campsites[2]



Share of annual overnight stays in July–September, %[3]

Campsites Hotels · Higher = more concentrated in summer



1 Change 2007–2025: campsites +2,54 M (6,79 to 9,33), hotels +1,31 M (10,93 to 12,24), rural tourism +0,13 M (0,22 to 0,35). In percent rural tourism grew most (+59,1%), from a small base.

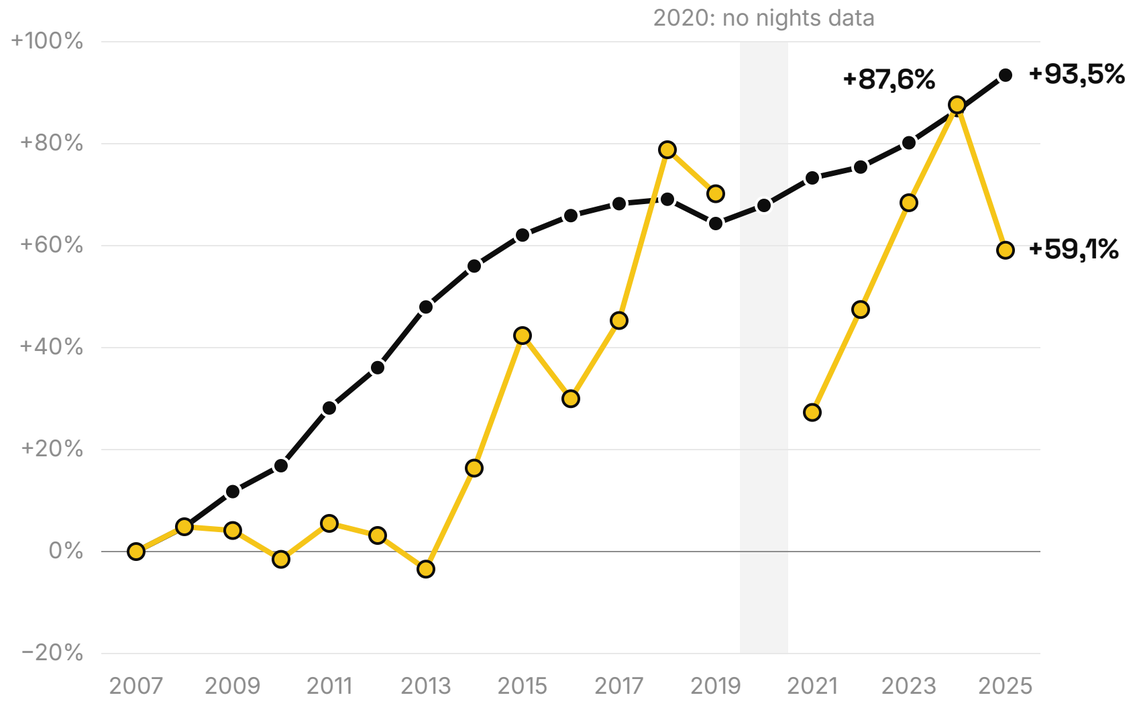
2 Campsite occupancy went from 39,2% in 2007 to 53,3% in 2025, while registered places went from 123.087 in 2011 to 117.582 in 2025 (−4,5%); campsite places are comparable only from 2011.

3 Share of the year's overnight stays that fall in July–September, in years with all four quarters available (no 2020). 2021 was a year of pandemic restrictions.

Source: Idescat, campsite occupancy survey (TURCAM), hotel occupancy survey (EOH) and supply of tourist establishments; author's calculations.

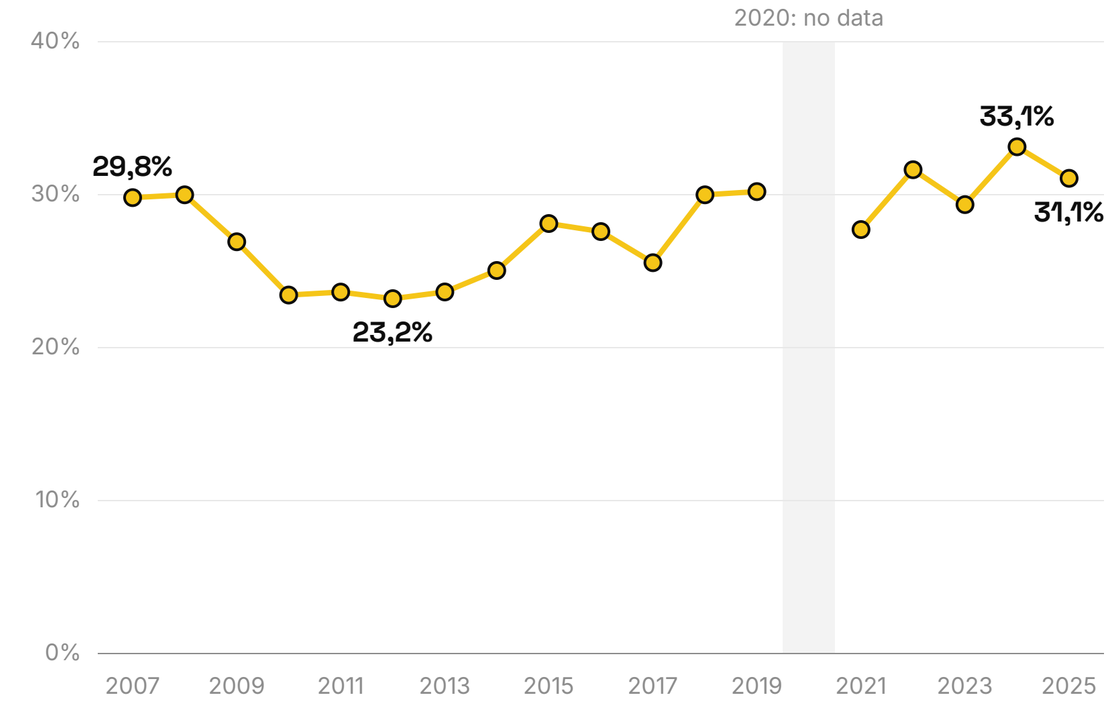
Rural tourism places rose 93,5% and nights 59,1%; occupancy stayed between 23% and 33%, and nights fell 15,2% in 2025.

Rural tourism: change since 2007, %[1,2]



Annual occupancy of rural tourism places, %[3]

Costa Brava tourist brand, rural tourism



1 Places (1.741 in 2007, 3.368 in 2025) are registered places in the comarques Alt Empordà, Baix Empordà and La Selva; nights (217,6k to 346,2k) are for the Costa Brava tourist brand. In 2025 rural tourism is 1,6% of the nights of the three types with demand data: a small base.

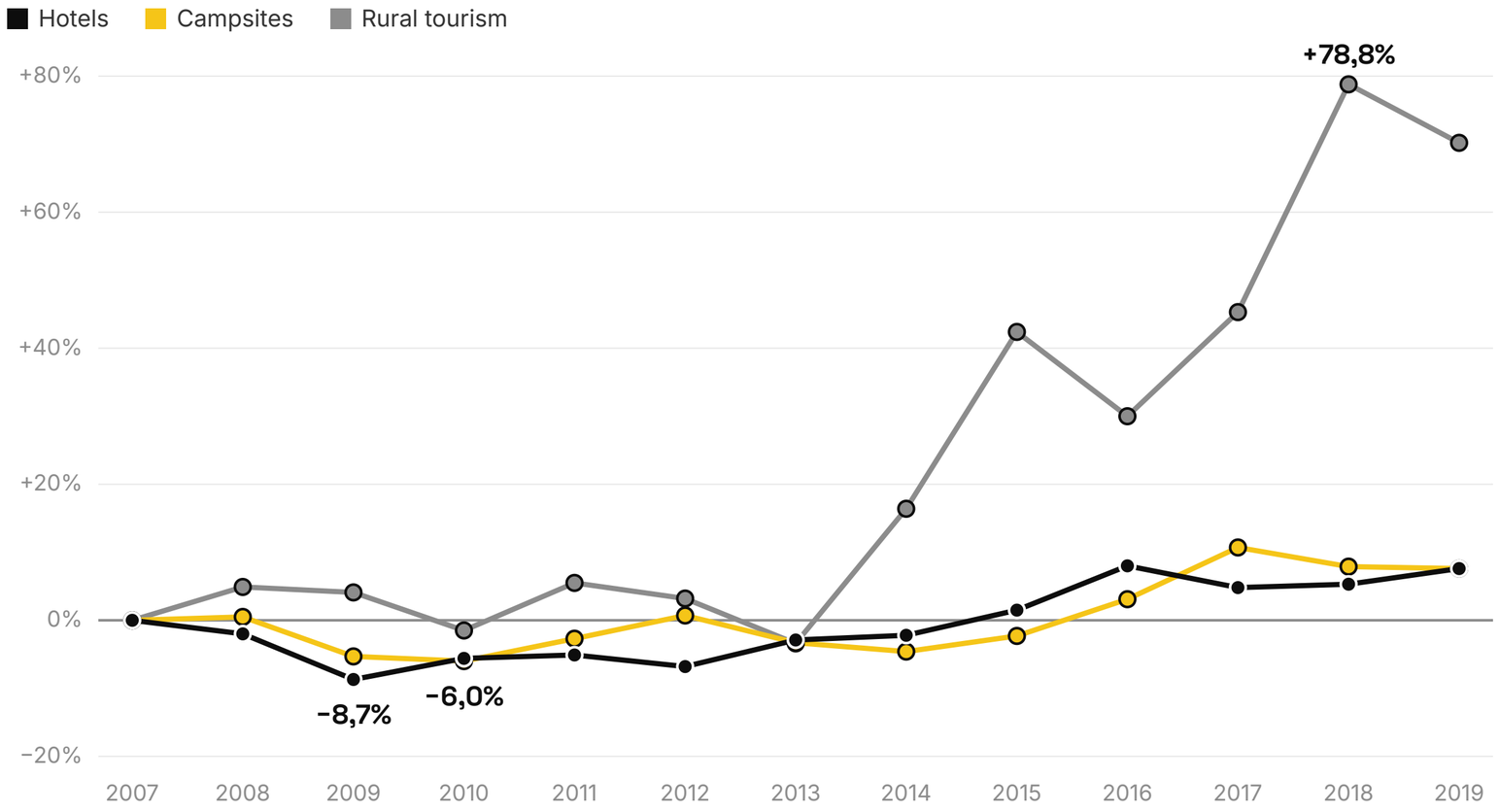
2 In 2025 rural nights fell 15,2% (408,3k in 2024 to 346,2k) while places rose 3,7% (3.247 to 3.368). This note does not test the cause of the fall.

3 Derived from the published quarterly occupancy rates, weighted by nights. No figure for 2020, when two quarters are missing in the source.

Source: Idescat, rural tourism occupancy survey (TURUR) and supply of tourist establishments; author's calculations.

Hotel nights regained their 2007 level in 2015 and campsites held it from 2016; rural nights never fell more than 3,4% below it.

Change in overnight stays since 2007, %[1]



NIGHTS COMPARED WITH 2007

Type	Lowest year	Back to 2007 level after the low	Above 2007 level from
Hotels	2009: −8,7%	2015 (8 yrs)	2015 (8 yrs)
Campsites	2010: −6,0%	2012 (5 yrs)	2016 (9 yrs)
Rural tourism	2013: −3,4%	2014 (7 yrs)	2014 (7 yrs)

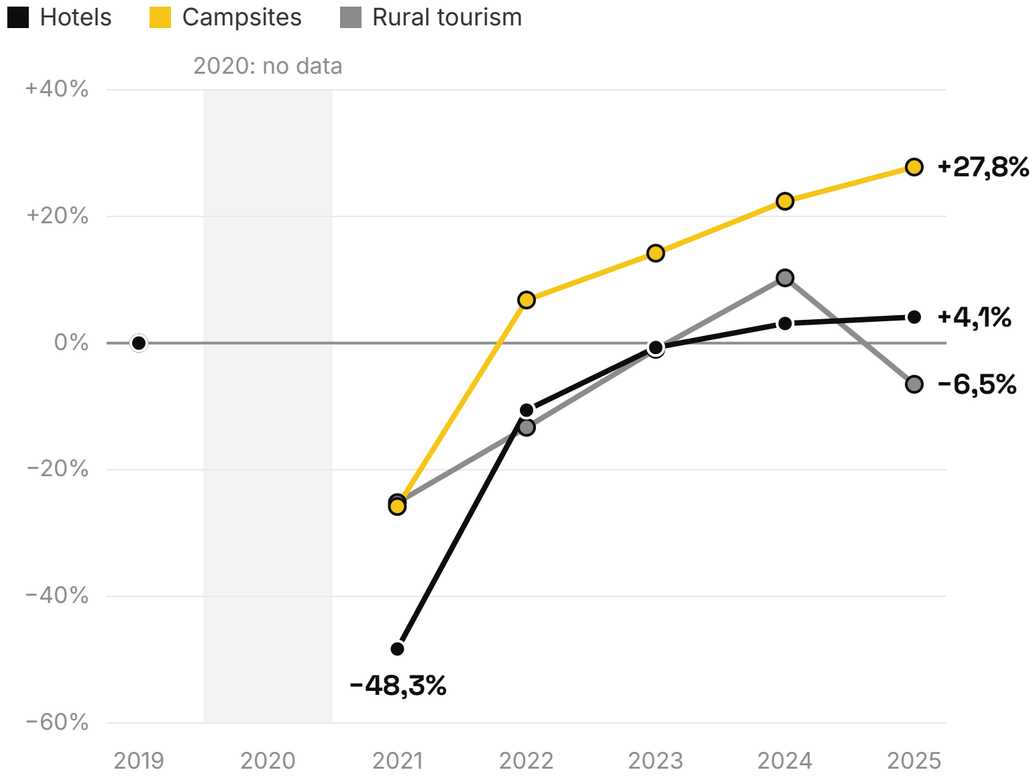
NOTES

1. 2007 is the first year in the data, so the starting level rests on a single year. Years in brackets are counted from 2007. Hotels include hostels and guesthouses; demand is the Costa Brava tourist brand.
2. Campsites reached +0,7% in 2012, fell to −3,3%, −4,6% and −2,3% in 2013–2015, and have been above their 2007 level since 2016. Rural tourism was below its 2007 level only in 2010 (−1,5%) and 2013 (−3,4%); it starts from 217,6k nights, so its percentages move more.
3. Hotel travellers were −2,4% in 2010 and −0,4% in 2011 against 2007, while hotel nights were −5,6% and −5,1%: stays were shorter.

Source: Idescat, hotel occupancy survey (EOH), campsite and rural tourism occupancy surveys; author's calculations.

Hotel nights took 8 years to return to their 2007 level after 2008 and 5 years to return to their 2019 level after covid.

After covid: change in overnight stays since 2019, %[1,2]



YEARS UNTIL NIGHTS RETURNED TO THE PRE-SHOCK LEVEL[1,3]

Type	After 2008 (from 2007)	After covid (from 2019)
Hotels	**2015 (8 yrs)** low 2009: −8,7%	**2024 (5 yrs)** low 2021: −48,3%
Campsites	**2012 (5 yrs)** low 2010: −6,0%; above from 2016 (9 yrs)	**2022 (3 yrs)** low 2021: −25,8%
Rural tourism	**2014 (7 yrs)** low 2013: −3,4%	**2024 (5 yrs)** low 2021: −25,2%; below again in 2025 (−6,5%)

NOTES

1. Years are counted from the last year before each shock, 2007 and 2019, to the first year at or above that level after the lowest observed year. The 2008 episode rests on a baseline of one year, the first in the data.
2. 2020 is missing for all three types, so the covid low cannot be seen; the lowest observed year is 2021, which still had restrictions.
3. Hotel travellers returned to their pre-shock level after 8 years (2015) and 4 years (2023). Hotels include hostels and guesthouses; demand is the Costa Brava tourist brand.

Source: Idescat, hotel occupancy survey (EOH), campsite and rural tourism occupancy surveys; author's calculations.

These data show supply and demand for three accommodation types; they do not show causes, spending or the use of tourist dwellings.

DATA USED: IDESCAT

Block	Measure	Period	Table
Hotels, demand[1]	Travellers, nights, occupancy	Monthly, 2007–2025	TURHOT 10289, 10292
Campsites, demand	Travellers, nights, occupancy	Quarterly, 2007–2025	TURCAM 18123, 18122
Rural tourism, demand	Travellers, nights, occupancy	Quarterly, 2007–2025	TURUR 10301, 10303
Hotels, supply[1]	Places	Annual, 2007–2025	TURALL 6031
Campsites, supply	Places	Annual, 2011–2025	TURALL 6036
Rural tourism, supply	Places	Annual, 2007–2025	TURALL 6039
Tourist dwellings, supply	Registered dwellings	Annual, 2015–2025	TURALL 16722
Tourist apartments, supply	Not analysed	Annual, 2015–2025	TURALL 16721

[1] Hotels include hostels and guesthouses, as in the hotel survey. Demand: Costa Brava tourist brand. Data downloaded on 19–20 October 2026; 2026 data are provisional and not used.

WHAT THE DATA CANNOT SAY

- No spending, visitors' origin or use of tourist dwellings: dwellings have supply data only, and registered places are not stays.
- Supply is the comarques Alt Empordà, Baix Empordà and La Selva, an approximation of the Costa Brava brand that demand measures.
- Places are registered capacity. Hotel occupancy is measured on the places estimated as open each month, so the two can move apart.
- 2020 is partly missing for all three types; no annual figure is computed for it.
- Campsite places are comparable only from 2011, when Idescat changed how they are counted.
- Categories show supply, not spending, and cannot tell upgrades from new builds. Regulation dates show timing, not cause. No page tests causes.

METHOD

- Annual occupancy: nights divided by available bed-nights, derived from the published monthly (hotels) or quarterly rates and weighted by nights.
- July–September is a calendar quarter, not a season definition.
- Differences between figures on a page are computed from the figures shown, so each page adds up.

OTHER SOURCES

- Hotel occupancy survey (EOH) methodology, INE, as published by Ibestat.
- Regulation of tourist dwellings: Decret 164/2010, Decret 159/2012, Decret 75/2020 and Decret llei 3/2023, as cited by Idescat (TURALL methodology) and the Begur town council.

Analysis and charts produced with Claude under the author’s direction. Author: Xavi Peña Gallego, October 2026.